

India's sporting economy finds its stride

From kabaddi to cricket, India's sports economy is booming. Worth USD 19 billion today, it's **being reshaped** by leagues, OTT platforms, private investment and policy reform — and could double by 2030.

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A decade ago, the business of sport in India was synonymous with cricket. Today, that's no longer true.

From kabaddi and hockey to kho-kho, volleyball and table tennis leagues, sport in India has evolved into a fast-growing, multi-billion-dollar ecosystem. According to *Sportlight: The Business of Sports in India 2025*, a report by KPMG in collaboration with *Sportstar*, the country's sports economy now stands at USD 19 billion and is projected to double to USD 40 billion by 2030, growing at 12–14 per cent each year.

What was once driven by fandom is now fuelled by finance, policy and technology. The rise of new leagues, digital broadcasting, private investment and state-led infrastructure has redefined the way sport is played, consumed and monetised in India.

Leagues lead the charge

Franchise-based leagues have become the heartbeat of India's sports economy. The Indian Premier League (IPL) remains its crown jewel, valued at USD 18 billion, but the

ecosystem is diversifying fast. The Pro Kabaddi League, Indian Super League and newer formats such as Prime Volleyball League and Pro Panja are building loyal audiences and sustainable commercial models.

The Women's Premier League (WPL) has been another breakthrough. Its media rights, sold for Rs. 951 crore (2023–27), show how women's sport is finally being treated as a serious business opportunity, not just an inclusion agenda. The Indian women's team's compelling performance in the Women's World Cup further demonstrates how the league structure is helping the game evolve to the next level.

Media revolution

Behind this surge is India's sports media boom. The IPL's USD 6.2 billion broadcast deal (2023–27) ranks among the most valuable in the world, surpassing some European football leagues on a per-match basis. More importantly, the way Indians watch sport has changed. OTT platforms such as JioHotstar, SonyLIV and FanCode have turned viewing into a digital, mobile-first experience. The IPL 2025 season alone reached

over 650 million viewers, proving that India is now one of the biggest sports-viewing markets on the planet.

Technology, manufacturing and esports

Innovation is the new playing field. The sports technology sector, valued at USD 1.6 billion, spans everything from data analytics and AI-based performance tools to wearable devices and OTT platforms. Indian start-ups in this space raised USD 180 million in venture funding last year, signalling investor confidence in sport as a scalable digital business.

At the same time, the sports goods and manufacturing industry, worth USD 6.7 billion and projected to reach USD 10 billion by 2030, continues to thrive. Cities such as Jalandhar and Meerut remain global supply hubs, exporting USD 470–500 million worth of equipment each year.

And then there's esports. Officially recognised by the government in 2022, India's gaming market has expanded to USD 340 million, with over 20 million active players. Competitive gaming, fantasy platforms and live streaming are drawing brands and broadcasters